Pitch please: Elevator pitching

Thursday 9 April 2020

Agenda

- A bit about me
- Where and when do elevator pitches happen?
- How to structure your pitch
- What's a nice-to-have?
- Top tips

A bit about me...

Tufts UNIVERSITY

Monitor Deloitte.

London Business School

Uber

Expedia

Context: where and when do elevator pitches happen?

zoom

Structuring your pitch

- Problem statement - what are you solving for and when/how did you realise this was a dire enough problem that it needed solving?
  - this needs to be super compelling so that it resonates easily with people. Using stats is useful here.
- Solution: how are you solving for it?
  - why is this the correct approach, and why is this business model the correct one to solve this problem?
  - team/founders - grit is super important. Founders that come out of a recession or emerged in a recession have grit. You want to also be able to attract the highest quality of people. The other thing is that you have the right background and experience
- Is there an actual market for this solution? And if not, are you creating a new one? And if so, how big that market?
- Competition and how you're differentiated
- Team: Why are you the best person to solve this problem/build this business?
- Your plan/roadmap
- Your ask

Nice-to-haves

- Passion: if you are not passionate about the problem you're solving and your proposed solution, you can't expect others to be
- Knowledge of the competition: If you are in a competitive space, be frank and direct about it and call it out. If you can clearly explain how you are differentiated, and display knowledge of the competition, even better.
- Your story: people want to know *why* you feel passionately about what you're building - if you have a personal story that inspired you, tell it

Top tips

- Use pigeonholes/labels/stereotypes to your advantage
  - Use terms that people can quickly identify and label - e.g. “I started my career in my management consulting” paints a picture for people very quickly about your work ethic, how you structure your thinking, etc.
- Use every opportunity to pitch yourself/your idea/your business

Thank you!